

Ellie (Gaeun) Choi

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F-1 Visa | STEM-OPT eligible — authorized to work up to 3 years without sponsorship

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Finance & Analytics: Financial reconciliation, budgeting & reporting, Excel modeling, SQL/MySQL, Python (pandas, matplotlib, scikit-learn), Tableau, Power BI

NLP & ML: FinBERT, VADER, Random Forest, LightGBM, XGBoost, Twitter API

Tools & Design: HTML, CSS, Java, GitHub, Adobe Creative Suite, Figma, Canva, Google Workspace

EDUCATION

M.S. in FinTech — University of Utah, David Eccles School of Business

Exp Jan 2027 — Exp. Dec 2028

Salt Lake City, UT

B.S. in Information Systems — University of Utah, David Eccles School of Business

Jan 2023– Dec 2026

Minors: Business Analytics & Urban Ecology and Planning | Relevant: Blockchain for Business, Cloud Computing, Visual Analytics, Data Structures

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Student Finance Operations Assistant

2026 — Present

College of Architecture & Planning, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Reconcile student finance transactions and operational records; apply accounting fundamentals to flag discrepancies and maintain data integrity across budgeting and reporting workflows.

Teaching Assistant — Information Systems

Aug 2025 — Present

David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Support IS 2010 & IS 3060 serving 100+ students through labs, grading, and 1-on-1 Excel financial modeling; TA for 2025 Adobe Social Impact Challenge.

IS Department Ambassador

Jun 2025 — Present

David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Liaison between IS students and faculty; produce promotional content and support program recruitment and outreach.

Lead Peer Advisor

Feb 2024 — Dec 2024

University of Utah Asia Campus | Incheon, South Korea

- Coordinated peer advising activities, mentored junior advisors, and facilitated workshops on course selection and career planning.
- Provided academic guidance and mentorship to 30+ business students per semester.

Computer Lab Assistant

Aug 2023 — Jun 2024

University of Utah Asia Campus | Incheon, South Korea

- Provided technical assistance including hardware/software troubleshooting, networking support, and printing/scanning help for students and faculty.
- Maintained lab operations and escalated issues to IT department as needed.

Internship — Travel & Cultural Project Management

Jul 2023

Kim's M&T | Seoul, South Korea

- Planned Korea cultural travel itineraries for foreign clients.
- Served as assistant staff for World Scout Jamboree 2023 and Manchester City Asia Tour.

RESEARCH/PROJECT

Predicting Stock Price Movements Using Market Data & Investor Sentiment

2026

Co-Author | Faculty Mentors: Emre Ertan, Chong Oh | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Evaluated EMH using S&P 500 data + FinBERT sentiment from financial news headlines; trained Random Forest, LightGBM, XGBoost — adding sentiment improved accuracy and reduced false positives, providing evidence against weak-form EMH.

A Multidimensional Framework for Winning Super Bowl Advertising— Super Bowl Ad ROI & Sentiment

2026

First Author | Faculty Advisor: Chong Oh | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Analyzed 64,230 tweets from 59 Super Bowl LX brands; engineered ROI Efficiency, Engagement Efficiency, Sustained Ratio, and 3 additional metrics into a composite Winning Score Model — $R^2 < 0.05$ vs. traditional Ad Meter rankings.

Salesforce-Eccles Ideathon

Sep 2025

David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Designed a Salesforce-based solution in a cross-functional business-tech competition.

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

- 1st Place, UAC Adobe Social Impact Challenge (Spring 2023) | Executive Director, ISB Club; VP, Accounting Club & TEK (IS) Club (2023–Present)